

Deltacarbon Tablet 250 mg

DESCRIPTION

Black round tablet with a break line on one side.
Each tablet contains medicinal (activated) charcoal 250 mg.

INDICATION

Deltacarbon is indicated for:

- Acute poisoning
- By preventing absorption of orally ingested poisonous substances and accelerating elimination of those substances, which are subject to enterohepatic circulation.
- Acute diarrhoea

DOSAGE AND ADMINISTRATION

Acute poisoning

A high dose of 0.5 – 1g/kg body weight must be administered in acute intoxications.

- Adults : 2 – 4 *Deltacarbon* tablet/kg body weight
- Children : 3 – 4 *Deltacarbon* tablet/kg body weight

Below is a summary of the recommended dosage: -

Age or body weight (kg)	Dosage
Adults and adolescents or > 60 kg body weight	120 – 240 <i>Deltacarbon</i> tablets
Children 10 – 12 years or > 30 kg body weight	90 – 120 <i>Deltacarbon</i> tablets
Children 6 – 9 years or > 20 kg body weight	60 – 80 <i>Deltacarbon</i> tablets
Children 3 – 5 years or > 15 kg body weight	45 – 60 <i>Deltacarbon</i> tablets
Children 1 – 2 years or > 10 kg body weight	30 – 40 <i>Deltacarbon</i> tablets

Administration of the slurry/suspension by gastric tube in unconscious patients should be done under medical supervision.

For elimination of poisonous substances, which are subject to enterohepatic circulation, the administration may be repeated at intervals of 2 – 4 hours. Should multiple dose administration be required, slurry/suspension can be given in isotonic saline or full electrolyte solution to rule out the risk of hypochloreaemia.

In addition, it is recommended to take sodium sulphate (1 tablespoonful for adult or ½ - 1 tablespoonful for children) with a glass of water 30 – 60 minutes later as this saline laxative induces rapid intestinal passage. This removes the poison that is bound to charcoal from gastrointestinal tract before part of the poisonous substance can be released.

Diarrhoea

- 2 – 4 *Deltacarbon* tablets are administered 3-4 times daily.
- Half of this dose is recommended for children.

Deltacarbon is not recommended for the treatment of diarrhoea for children under 6 years of age.

Deltacarbon should be taken on an empty stomach with plenty of liquid. This medication should be taken until the stools have returned to normal. Other therapeutic and diagnostic measures should be taken if patient does not respond to treatment after 3 days.

The tablet(s) should be taken orally. It can be taken whole or be crushed into powder and taken with liquid as a slurry.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Deltacarbon is contraindicated in those patients with absence of bowel sounds, GI perforation, intestinal obstruction, recent surgery, risk of GI haemorrhage, febrile diarrhoea and hypersensitive to any of the excipients.

WARNINGS AND PRECAUTIONS

Not recommended for treatment of diarrhoea in children under 6 years of age.

Medicinal charcoal may interfere with the absorption of other drugs, including antibiotics, when administered concurrently. As an adsorbent, medicinal charcoal should be taken 2 hours after or before consuming other drugs, including antibiotics, food, nutritional supplement or herb. However this effect is not important if the medicinal charcoal is used in treating acute poisoning.

Appropriate fluid and electrolyte therapy should be given to protect against dehydration. Oral rehydration therapy which is the use of appropriate fluids including oral rehydration salts remains the most effective treatment for dehydration due to diarrhoea. The intake of as much of these fluids as possible is therefore imperative.

Medicinal charcoal should be used in caution in unconscious or drowsy patients due to risk of aspiration. Doctors should ensure airway of the patient is protected.

Patients with reduced gastrointestinal motility are in a risk of obstruction. Saline laxatives such as sodium sulphate should be given as prevention.

Medicinal charcoal is not effective in managing poisoning caused by corrosive products or petroleum because it may make the condition worse and hinder endoscopic evaluation of the gastro-esophageal lining.

Medicinal charcoal is also not effective in intoxications with substances like lithium, thallium, cyanide, iron salts, methanol, ethanol and ethylene glycol. Specific oral antidotes are indicated for these substances: -

Substance	Specific antidote
Cyanide	4-Dimethylaminophenol
Ethylene glycol	Ethanol
Iron compounds	Deferoxamine (desferrioxamine)
Lithium	Calcium polystyrene sulfonate
Methanol	Ethanol

In many intoxications, a specific antidote must be administered in addition to medicinal charcoal. For instance, acetylcysteine is used in addition to medicinal charcoal in paracetamol poisoning.

Effects on Ability to Drive and Use Machine

The use of this medicine does not have any adverse effects on the driving ability and the ability to handle machinery.

DRUG INTERACTIONS

Co-administration of medicinal charcoal with other drugs will reduce the effectiveness of these drugs.

PREGNANCY AND LACTATION

Available evidence is inconclusive or is inadequate for determining foetal risk when used in pregnant women or women of childbearing potential and during breast feeding. Weigh the potential benefits of drug treatment against potential risks before prescribing this drug during pregnancy.

SIDE EFFECTS

Medicinal charcoal is relatively non-toxic when given orally but gastrointestinal disturbances such as vomiting, constipation, or diarrhoea have been reported. Medicinal charcoal will produce black stools as it is excreted in an unchanged form.

Medicinal charcoal has been associated with bezoar formation, intestinal obstruction and rarely, intestinal perforation with multiple dosing, although a direct causative association has not been demonstrated.

Aspiration of medicinal charcoal in unconscious or drowsy patients has been reported to cause airway obstruction. Appropriate precautions should be taken. Consult the doctor if other effects occur.

SYMPTOMS & TREATMENTS OF OVERDOSAGE

Symptoms of severe constipation would result from excessive use and this could be treated with laxatives. However, there is a rare report of acute appendicitis in a patient who was given multiple doses of medicinal charcoal. Treatment is symptomatic.

PHARMACODYNAMICS

Medicinal charcoal is an effective adsorbent of a wide variety of drugs and chemicals and thus reduces their absorption from the gastrointestinal tract (GI). The very fine particle size of medicinal charcoal increases its overall surface area and adsorptive capacity. Medicinal charcoal is also found to adsorb enzymes, vitamins, amino acids, minerals and other nutrients from the GI. However, medicinal charcoal does not adsorb alcohols, hydrocarbon, lithium, strong acids and bases, metals and inorganic minerals.

PHARMACOKINETICS

Medicinal charcoal is neither absorbed in the gastrointestinal tract nor metabolized, and all ingested medicinal charcoal is excreted in the faeces.

PACK SIZE

Alu-PVC blister pack of 50, 100 or 500 tablets.

STORAGE CONDITIONS & PHARMACEUTICAL PRECAUTIONS

Do not store above 30°C.

Protect from light.

Keep out of reach of children.

Jauhi daripada kanak-kanak.

Shelf-life: Please refer to the outer box label.

Manufactured by:



SRIPRASIT PHARMA CO., LTD.

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Samut Sakhon 74110, Thailand.

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